

LYCANTHROPE IN EBERRON

What if werewolves of Eberron were twelve different “tribes”, each impacted by a different moon of Eberron?

This book is inspired by the homebrewed lunar calendar of Eberron by abexy and the classical World of Darkness game, Werewolf: the Apocalypse by White Wolf.

The rules are intended for players to play as lycanthropes, specifically werewolves, in Eberron campaigns.

NEW RULES OF LYCANTROPY

In D&D 5e, lycanthropy is a curse or disease that can be contracted through a bite or scratch from a lycanthrope. In this version, lycanthropy comes in two forms: a **hereditary** form passed down through bloodlines, and a **contracted** form that is caught like a disease. If it is hereditary, the character is born with lycanthropy, and this cannot be removed, short of a *wish* spell.

HEREDITARY LYCANTHROPY

A character with either a parent with hereditary lycanthropy has a 50% chance of inheriting the trait. If both parents have hereditary lycanthropy, it is guaranteed. The probability decreases to 25% if only one grandparent has hereditary lycanthropy, and 12.5% if only one great-grandparent has it, and so on. Overall, in the world of Eberron, hereditary lycanthropy is rare but persistent.

Werewolves, the most common type of hereditary lycanthropes, have an affinity to one of the twelve moons of Eberron, which influences their lycanthropic form and abilities. Werewolves of the same moon tend to form close-knit packs or tribes, often centered around shared beliefs and customs related to their moon.

Through parent to cub, werewolves pass down not only their lycanthropic nature but also knowledge of their moon’s influence, rituals, and traditions. Each one of the moons correspond to a tribe, and the traditions are detailed below.

Finally, werewolves with hereditary lycanthropy have control over their transformations, and are able to hold in-between forms as well - five forms in total.

CONTRACTED LYCANTHROPY

A character bitten or scratched by a lycanthrope must make a DC 12 Constitution saving throw.

On a failed save, the character “is cursed” with lycanthropy, as per the original rules.

They cannot pass this on to their offspring, even if they become a lycanthrope themselves. They can, however “infest” others through bites and scratches, as per the original rules.

If they embrace their lycanthropy, they can get feats to control their transformations and gain abilities based on the moon that influenced the lycanthrope that infected them.

They gain all the benefits and drawbacks of lycanthropy, including the five forms detailed below.

THE FORMS

A lycanthrope has five forms:

- **Humanoid Form:** The lycanthrope appears as a normal humanoid of their race.
- **Shifter Form:** The lycanthrope takes on a mix of humanoid and animal features, gaining some of the abilities of their animal form. In this form, they resemble Shifters.
- **Hybrid Form:** This is the hybrid form from D&D 5e.
- **Dire Form:** The lycanthrope takes on a larger and more powerful version of their animal form, gaining enhanced abilities.
- **Animal Form:** The lycanthrope fully transforms into their animal form.

To shift between these forms, the lycanthrope must use an action on their turn. They can shift only to the next form up or down the list as one action. For example, they can shift from Humanoid to Shifter, or from Hybrid to Dire, but not Humanoid to Hybrid takes two turns.

This transformation, “shifting”, requires a DC 10 Wisdom check. If their moon is dark (new moon), the check is made with disadvantage. If their moon is full, the check is made with

OVERPOWERED LYCANTHROPY

Hereditary Lycanthropy is overpowered in the spirit of the “Werewolf: the Apocalypse” which this is inspired by. The DM can use these rules to create powerful NPC lycanthropes, that is an option. However, the intention is to play a game with themes from Werewolf: the Apocalypse: personal horror, fight against cosmic forces, the balance between human and beast, and the struggle to maintain one’s humanity.

ORIGINAL D&D LYCANTHROPY

The rules in this book are written for consistency with the original D&D 5e werewolf. The 5e monster stat block for werewolves roughly corresponds to the Hybrid form detailed below, for an NPC.

advantage. To determine the phase of the moon, either use a d10, with 1 being new moon and 0 being full moon, or use the amazine the homebrewed lunar calendar of Eberron by abexy.¹

The transformation is a magical effect. On the turn, this will register as such on spells like *detect magic*. It can be suppressed by *antimagic field* or similar effects, but not dispelled. At the DM's discretion, *counterspell* may be used to prevent a lycanthrope from shifting if cast as a reaction before they use their action to shift. Alternatively, the roll may be made at a disadvantage. The lycanthrope can try again on their next turn.

Each one of the forms come with their own set of abilities and traits, which are detailed in the next sections for werewolves.

HUMANOID FORM

In this form, the werewolf appears as a normal humanoid of their race.

Keen Hearing and Smell. The werewolf has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing and smell on all five forms.

SHIFTER FORM

In this form, the werewolf resembles a Longtooth Shifter with relatively heavy build and will likely be mistaken for one.²

Attribute Bonuses. Their Strength increases by 2, up to a maximum of 25, and their Dexterity increases by 1, also up to a maximum of 25.

Darkvision. They gain Darkvision out to 60 feet if they don't already have it, and if they have it, it is increased to 120 feet.

Damage Resistance. They gain resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical weapons that aren't silvered.

Keen Hearing and Smell. The werewolf has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing and smell on all five forms.

Claw Attack. Their unarmed strikes deal 1d6 slashing damage, plus their strength modifier. They count as magical for the purpose of overcoming resistance and immunity to nonmagical attacks and damage. They are proficient with this attack.

Bite Attack. They can use their action to make a bite attack, dealing 1d6 piercing damage plus their strength modifier. They are proficient with this attack. This attack can also transmit

lycanthropy if the target fails a DC 12 Constitution saving throw.

Temporary Hit Points. When they shift into this form, they gain temporary hit points equal to their level + their Constitution modifier.

Pack Tactics. If they have an ally within 5 feet of their target, they have advantage on attack rolls against that target.

Proficiency Bonus. They gain proficiency with Perception skills.

HYBRID FORM

This is the majestic, impressive werewolf look - it is the hybrid form from D&D 5e.

Attribute Bonuses. Their Strength increases by 6 from their human form, up to a maximum of 25, and their Dexterity increases by 3, also up to a maximum of 25.

Darkvision. They gain Darkvision up to 120 feet if they don't already have it.

Damage Immunity. They gain immunity to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical weapons that aren't silvered.

Lack of Speech. They lose the ability to speak, and social checks other than Intimidation are automatically failed.

Frightful Presence. Finally, the people who see them must succeed on a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened for 1 minute. A frightened target can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

Keen Hearing and Smell. The werewolf has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing and smell on all five forms.

Two attack rolls. They can make two attacks: one with their claws and one with their bite.

Claw Attack. Their unarmed strikes deal 2d4 slashing damage, plus their strength modifier. They count as magical for the purpose of overcoming resistance and immunity to nonmagical attacks and damage. They are proficient with this attack.

Bite Attack. They can use their action to make a bite attack, dealing 1d8 piercing damage plus their strength modifier. They are proficient with this attack. This attack can also transmit lycanthropy if the target fails a DC 12 Constitution saving throw.

Temporary Hit Points. When they shift into this form, they gain temporary hit points equal to twice their level + their Constitution modifier. (Not stacking with the increase from the Shifter form.)

Speed Increase. Their base speed increases by 10 feet.

¹There are other sources about the cosmology of the moons in Eberron.

²If a check is needed, the DC is 19 to identify them as a lycanthrope rather than a Shifter on a Nature (Wis) or Arcana (Int) check. However, unless there is a specific reason to suspect a lycanthrope, people will assume they are a Shifter without any checks.

Pack Tactics. If they have an ally within 5 feet of their target, they have advantage on attack rolls against that target.

Proficiency Bonus. They gain proficiency with Athletics, Intimidation and Perception skills.

DIRE FORM

In this form, the werewolf takes on a look similar to a dire wolf, but larger and more powerful.

Attribute Bonuses. Their Strength increases by 4 from their human form, up to a maximum of 25, and their Dexterity increases by 2, also up to a maximum of 25.

Darkvision. They gain Darkvision out to 60 feet if they don't already have it, and if they have it, it is increased to 120 feet.

Damage Resistance. They gain resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical weapons that aren't silvered.

Lack of Speech. They lose the ability to speak, and social checks other than Intimidation are automatically failed.

Keen Hearing and Smell. The werewolf has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing and smell on all five forms.

Bite Attack. They can use their action to make a bite attack, dealing 1d8 piercing damage plus their strength modifier. They are proficient with this attack. This attack can also transmit lycanthropy if the target fails a DC 12 Constitution saving throw.

Proficiency Bonus. They gain proficiency with Stealth and Perception skills.

THE MOONS

ZARANTYR, THE STORM MOON

OLARUNE, THE SENTINEL

THERENDOR, THE HEALER'S MOON

EYRE, THE ANVIL

DRAVAGO, THE HERDING MOON

NYMM, THE CROWN

LHARVION, THE EYE

BARRAKAS, THE LANTERN

RHAAN, THE BOOK

SYPHEROS, THE SHADOW

ARYTH, THE GATEWAY

VULT, THE WARDING MOON

CRYA, THE LOST MOON

HISTORY OF LYCANTHROPY IN EBERRON